



BEATING THE CHILL

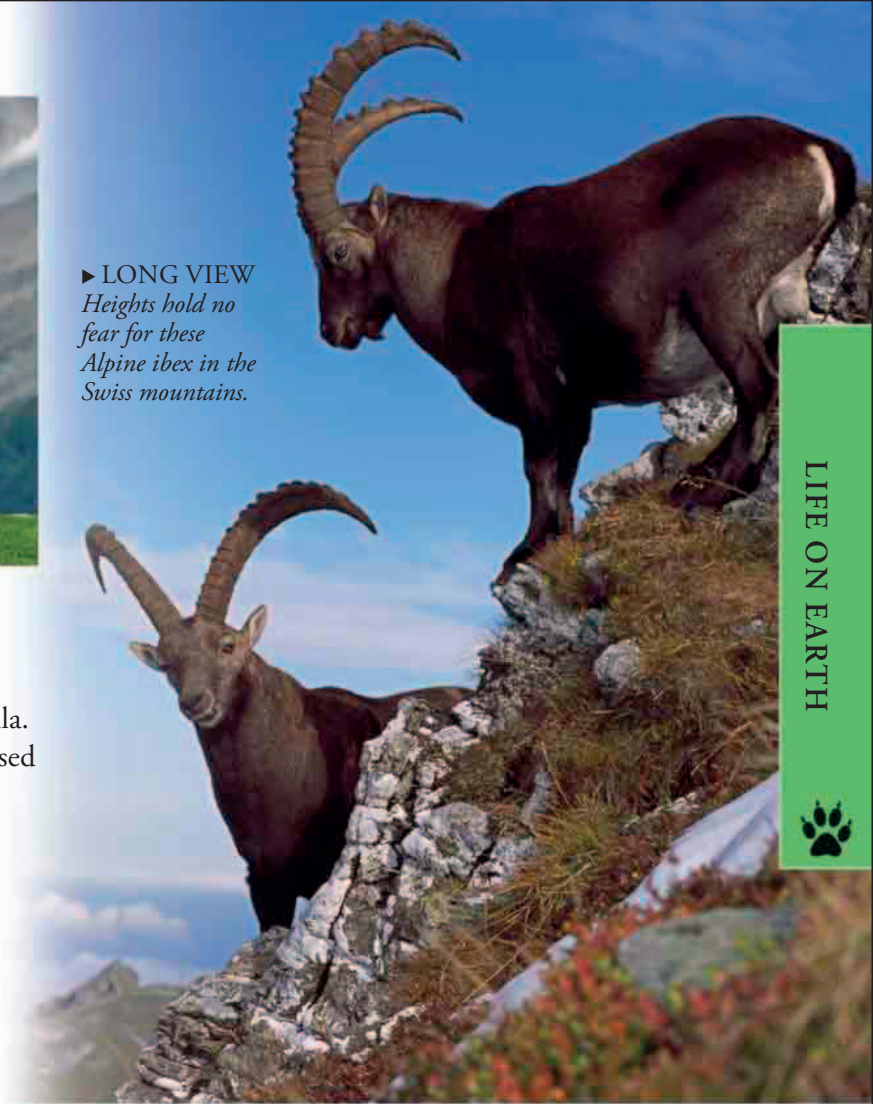
Many mountain animals have thick woolly coats to keep out the cold wind. They include this Andean llama, the angora, the mountain goat, and the squirrel-like chinchilla. Angora and llama wool is famously warm, and is often used to make winter clothing.



FRAGILE BEAUTY

Despite the cold nights, several insect species thrive in the mountains. This Apollo butterfly lives in the flower meadows of high European mountains. Each butterfly group stays on its own mountain without interbreeding, and this has led to the evolution of many local subspecies.

► **LONG VIEW**
Heights hold no fear for these Alpine ibex in the Swiss mountains.



LIFE ON EARTH



PEAK CONDITION

Rugged peaks and crags are dangerous places, and one wrong step can be fatal. Over time, this has ensured that only the most sure-footed animals survive long enough to breed. This harsh form of natural selection has resulted in the evolution of such amazingly agile creatures as the European chamois and ibex, and the American mountain goat.



ISOLATION

Some mountains are surrounded by farms that keep animals from traveling in search of breeding partners. This can lead to dangerous inbreeding—one reason why the giant panda has become so rare in the mountains of China. Animals' mountain habitats are also being destroyed by rising global temperatures.